

After Root Canal Treatment

Simple after-care instructions for a comfortable recovery and protection of your treated tooth

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild tenderness or sensitivity when biting can occur for a few days while the tissues around the tooth settle. Jaw soreness may also occur.

REMEMBER

Your tooth may feel different for a short time. Follow your dentist's specific instructions, especially if a temporary filling or crown is present.

1. For the first few hours

- Wait until the numbness wears off before eating so you do not accidentally bite your cheek, lip or tongue.
- Avoid very hot food or drinks while the area is still numb.
- Follow any specific instructions given by your dentist.

2. Eating and chewing

- Do not chew hard or sticky foods on the treated tooth until the permanent restoration has been placed and your dentist advises normal use.
- Choose softer foods if the tooth is tender. Avoid ice, hard candy and other very hard objects.
- If a temporary filling or crown is present, take extra care because it is not as strong as the final restoration.

3. Pain or tenderness

- Mild discomfort or tenderness for a few days can be normal and should gradually improve.
- Use pain-relieving medication only as advised by your dentist/doctor and according to the medication instructions. Do not exceed the recommended dose.
- A cold compress on the outside of the cheek for short periods may help with mild swelling or soreness.

4. Brushing and flossing

- Continue normal oral hygiene. Brush twice daily and floss regularly unless your dentist has advised otherwise.
- Be gentle around the treated tooth if the area feels tender.
- Keeping the tooth and gums clean helps protect the tooth and its final restoration.

5. Do not delay the final restoration

- **A root-canal-treated tooth still needs protection.** Arrange the recommended permanent filling, onlay or crown as soon as advised. A tooth that remains temporarily restored can be more vulnerable to fracture and leakage. The final restoration helps protect the tooth and restore normal function.

6. When should you contact us?

- **Contact your dentist promptly if you develop:**
 - Severe or worsening pain
 - Significant swelling inside or outside the mouth
 - Fever or feeling unwell
 - Your bite feels unusually high or uneven
 - The temporary filling/crown comes out
 - Previous symptoms return
- **Difficulty swallowing or breathing — seek urgent medical/dental care.**

Important: These are general patient-education instructions and do not replace personalised advice from your treating dentist.

References

1. American Association of Endodontists. Post Treatment Care. Patient education resource.
2. American Association of Endodontists. Root Canal Explained. Patient education resource.
3. Duncan HF, et al. Endodontic S3-level clinical practice guidelines. Br Dent J. 2025;238:580–586.
4. European Society of Endodontology. Position statement: The restoration of root filled teeth. Int Endod J. 2021.